

# SAVANNAH ELLISON

Department of Economics, Georgia Institute of Technology

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## EDUCATION

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**Georgia Institute of Technology**, Atlanta, GA

PhD in Economics; Minor in Higher Education

*Expected May 2027*

MS in Economics

2026

**University of St. Thomas**, Saint Paul, MN

BS in Mathematical Economics; Minor in American Culture and Difference

2022

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

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Health Economics, Applied Microeconomics

## JOB MARKET PAPER

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### **The Effect of Pre-Exposure Prophylaxis for HIV Access on Bacterial STIs**

*Abstract:* The treatment and prevention of HIV have improved substantially over the past three decades. One major development is pre-exposure prophylaxis (PrEP), medication taken routinely to prevent HIV transmission. By reducing the risk of HIV infection, PrEP may reduce incentives for safer sex. Because PrEP offers no protection against bacterial sexually transmitted infections like syphilis, these behavioral responses may increase syphilis incidence. At the same time, more frequent STI screening is recommended for PrEP users, potentially increasing detection. The rise in syphilis diagnoses following PrEP's 2012 FDA approval may therefore reflect changes in both incidence and detection. Using Medicaid claims from 2010–2022, I estimate difference-in-differences models of syphilis diagnosis, testing, and yield rates, exploiting cross-state variation in the pre-treatment share of cohabiting male same-sex couple households (MSS) as a proxy for differential exposure to PrEP. A one-standard-deviation increase in MSS increases the syphilis yield rate by an estimated 0.319 percentage points, and the diagnosis rate by 22.3 per 100,000 beneficiaries, equivalent to increases of 54.9% and 61.7% relative to their respective 2011 baseline means. The estimated effect on testing is positive but statistically imprecise. Together, the increases in diagnoses and yield suggest increased underlying syphilis incidence and indicate that greater detection alone cannot explain the rise in diagnoses.

## WORKING PAPERS

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### **ACA Medicaid Expansion and Contraceptive Provision to Teens**

with Melanie Guldi, Mayra Pineda-Torres, and Sarah Rosenberg

## WORKS IN PROGRESS

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### **The Effect of Economic Shocks on Personal Hygiene Consumption**

### **Evolving Trends in Contraceptive Choice: Understanding the Role of Medical Providers**

with Melanie Guldi, Mayra Pineda-Torres, and Sarah Rosenberg

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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**Research Assistant**, Georgia Institute of Technology

*Summer 2024 – Summer 2025*

Supervisor: Dr. Jason Lindo

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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### **Instructor of Record**, Georgia Institute of Technology

- Statistics for Economists Fall 2025

### **Teaching Assistant**, Georgia Institute of Technology

- The Global Economy Fall 2026
- Principles of Microeconomics Summer 2023, Spring 2024, Spring 2026
- Behavioral Economics Fall 2023
- PhD Math for Economists Fall 2023
- Health Economics Spring 2023
- Industrial Organization Fall 2022, Spring 2023

## HONORS & AWARDS

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|------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| President's Fellowship                               | 2022 – 2026 |
| Joseph B. Owens Fellowship                           | 2023-2026   |
| Outstanding Graduate Student Instructor (Economics)  | Fall 2025   |
| IAC Student Research Conference, Best Lightning Talk | Spring 2026 |

## PRESENTATIONS

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**2026:** IAC Student Research Conference, ASHEcon, SEA\*, APPAM\*

\*Scheduled

## SKILLS

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**Programming:** Stata, R, SQL, Python

**Languages:** English (native), Spanish (advanced)